

ID: SOMA-M-P03

Title: Being with the Present

Duration: 10m 00s (712 words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we will explore the practice of being more present and tuned in to this moment. We will do this by intentionally tuning into our experience with a kindly attention, from moment to moment. If it's safe for you to do so, let's practice this way of paying attention to some of what might be going on - inside and outside of us.

You can expect to hear a sequence of brief suggestions, each followed by some time to practice. Starting with your posture. It's helpful to adopt a posture that supports stability, alertness, and comfort – sitting or standing, or lying down. Keeping your eyes open.

If you are sitting, it may be helpful to have your legs uncrossed, and your feet placed flat on the floor. If you prefer to move during this practice, that is absolutely fine. You might wiggle your fingers or toes. You might roll your shoulders gently. And if any part of your experience becomes too uncomfortable, feeling free to pause this practice.

[Short Pause] (10s - Settling in)

And now, inviting a sense of gentleness to this practice by softening your gaze and then bringing your attention to your sense of sight. With a few moments now to practice seeing what may be present in your environment, by paying kindly attention on purpose. Shapes, objects, colors... As best you can, simply noticing, without thinking about what you see.

[Long Pause] (25s - Visual practice)

And now allowing the eyes to gently close if you like, but equally feeling free to keep them open. When you're ready, now opening to listening with awareness. Purposefully listening to the presence of any sounds.

Allowing the ears to receive sounds from your environment. Sounds near, and sounds further away. Not hunting for sounds, but allowing them to arrive to your ears. If there are no sounds present, acknowledging that as part of your present-moment experience. Perhaps noticing what is like to experience silence, the absence of sound. Listen one moment at a time. Notice how sounds come and go. Notice when one sound changes to another.

[Long Pause] (25s - Auditory practice)

And now, an invitation to bring your attention to this body, in your chosen posture or perhaps making some small adjustments if that is helpful. Getting a sense of the whole body, resting in this stillness, or with gentle movement. And being curious about what the body may be experiencing from moment to moment.

Notice where the body touches the chair or the floor. Notice any sensations that are here. You might feel warmth, tingling, or pressure.

[Short Pause] (10s - Tactile check-in)

Maybe also noticing how your body is breathing in this moment, without needing to change the way you are breathing. You might also bring your attention to the immediate space around the body. The contact of air with the skin. And is there any temperature in the air you can notice?

One moment at a time, purposefully noticing any and all sensations that may be present in and around the body. A sense of being with the body as it is, without the need to change anything in your experience. Full intentional and kindly awareness of the body, from moment to moment. And remember that you can pause the practice should certain sensations be too uncomfortable for you.

[Long Pause] (25s - Somatic awareness)

From time to time, you may notice your attention is pulled away by sounds. This is entirely normal. It is not a mistake. When this happens, simply knowing that sound is here, and then paying attention to the body again.

Or perhaps your attention gets pulled away by thoughts. Here too, this is not a mistake. The invitation is to acknowledge that thoughts are here. Again and again, gently and intentionally guiding your attention back to the body. So with this kind approach towards our exploration of our body, we continue to practice.

[Short Pause] (10s - Refocusing transition)

One moment at a time. Paying kindly attention, deliberately, to your present-moment experience. Being with this moment. Just as it is. Observing with curiosity. Noticing any and all sensations.

[Short Pause] (10s - Closing transition)

And now, we will gently bring this practice to a close. It may be helpful to get a sense of the whole body sitting or standing or lying. Perhaps taking a deeper breath or two if you like, and then opening your eyes if they were closed.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Thank you for your practice.

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